RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 18, 2026

Trending now — 3 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	**7-Eleven confirmed it's closing roughly 645 stores by February 2027** (per a Seven & i Holdings filing) as it shifts toward larger "food-forward" locations with expanded kitchens, seating, and fresh/prepared food — while also planning 550 new stores (205 in the same fiscal period) built to that bigger format.	ABC News 4 — 7-Eleven to close nearly 650 stores as it shifts to 'food-forward' locations; DesignRush — 7-Eleven Plans 645 Closures, Expands Food-Forward Stores	**LinkedIn, owner-to-owner operations post.** "7-Eleven just confirmed it's closing roughly 645 stores while it doubles down on bigger, food-forward locations with full kitchens and expanded seating. The lesson for independent store owners isn't 'build a kitchen' — it's that the stores pulling ahead right now are the ones that know exactly what they're built to do and run it with the right systems, instead of spreading thin trying to be everything. Worth asking: is your setup built for what your store actually is?" No pricing claim — pure operational-strategy commentary.

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
2	**“Ramalama Costume Walk” is a live TikTok trend** — creators use Róisín Murphy’s “Ramalama (Bang Bang)” as the soundtrack for a dramatic, slow-motion costume-reveal walk toward the camera. A specific, currently-usable video format, distinct from generic costume-trend coverage already used this month.	New Engen — October 2026 TikTok Trends: Viral Moments You Need to Know	**TikTok/Instagram Reels, native trend-format post.** Use the exact trending audio for a staff-member costume-reveal walk through the store toward camera — light, native-feeling seasonal content with zero product claims, riding the trend’s own format rather than pitching anything. Halloween is 13 days out, so timing is right to post this week.
3	**A Kentucky legislative committee presentation dated Oct 15, 2026 laid out specific federal guardrails now on the table for hemp products** ahead of the Dec 11 deadline — age-gating to 21+, mandatory good manufacturing practices, mandatory third-party lab testing, and a potency cap per serving. A fresh, dated detail beyond the deadline/stockpiling angle already covered — the first specific look at what the new compliance bar will actually require.	Kentucky Legislature — L&O Committee Presentation, Oct 15, 2026 (PDF)	**LinkedIn/Instagram, CBD/hemp retailer compliance post.** “A state legislative committee this week laid out the federal guardrails now on the table for hemp products once the Dec 11 deadline hits — age-gating to 21+, mandatory lab testing, a potency cap per serving. None of this is finalized yet, but it’s the clearest signal so far of where compliance is heading. If you sell CBD/hemp products, this is worth watching closely over the next few weeks, not scrambling over once it’s final.” Factual, forward-looking, no product claims — age-gating is presented as a compliance signal, not a product plug.

Skipped, no genuine angle today: TikTok's "Two Fishes" audio (Corbin Mims / Love Island) — real and current, but every brand-twist attempt felt forced; holding rather than stretching it. NRF's $13.5B Halloween spending survey (47% now using AI tools to shop, candy at $4.1B) — the headline figures were already used Oct 9 and Oct 15; the one new data point (AI-tool usage) is too thin to justify a repeat Halloween post this soon. Loyalty-program industry data (89% of retailers now have a program, Circle K point-earning expansion) — sources date to August 2026, not fresh enough to call "trending now." Diwali 2026 retail news — no dated news found from this week specifically; the gifting-occasion angle was already used Oct 13 and Oct 15. World Series/MLB — held per standing plan until the Series itself starts Oct 23; ALCS opponent wasn't yet confirmed in available sources. UK Tobacco and Vapes Act — still UK-specific and structurally repetitive of the NC electronic-age-verification angle already used and skipped Oct 17.

Compliance check: none of the three ideas imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #1 is pure retail-operations commentary with no age-restricted product mention; #2 is a neutral seasonal trend-format post with no product claim; #3 presents hemp compliance guardrails (age-gating included) as a forward-looking regulatory signal, not a product promotion.